

SABASTIAN BENAVIDEZ

(505) 480-7298 Sebastian.j.Benavidez@gmail.com Albuquerque, NM Active U.S. Top Secret Clearance

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Process-oriented Senior Program Finance Lead and MBA (Finance/Operations) with an Active Top Secret Clearance and 5+ years of experience in program financial oversight, workflow optimization, and high-stakes system implementation. Expert in bridging the gap between operational requirements and financial execution, with a proven track record of driving margin performance in federal (DCSA) and commercial environments. Adept at building scalable quantitative models and managing complex program budgets to support mission-critical autonomous aircraft initiatives.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency (DCSA)

June 2025 - Present

General Student Trainee (GS-07)

- Support digital enhancement and financial optimization for federal background investigation workflows, ensuring 100% operational integrity and fiscal alignment.
- Research and gather functional requirements for generative AI implementations, evaluating cost-benefit impacts and resource allocation needs.
- Apply rigorous analytical principles to identify process gaps in federal workflows, driving efficiencies that support strict compliance with budgetary guidelines.

Freelance Consulting

2016 - 2020

Senior Program Management Consultant

- Directed end-to-end financial and operational lifecycles for complex media programs, managing resource allocation and creative scheduling to ensure 100% on-time delivery.
- Designed and deployed operational workflows for content distribution, reducing lead times and optimizing unit cost drivers for diverse client portfolios.
- Integrated cross-functional technical and business requirements to provide actionable strategic recommendations for system enhancements and margin improvement.

Kelly Education

January 2025 - June 2025

Operations Coordinator

- Managed stakeholder expectations and guided diverse groups of 30+ individuals daily, demonstrating the persuasion required for floor-level adoption of new institutional processes.

EDUCATION

MBA in Finance & Operations (GPA: 4.16)

University of New Mexico

B.S. Business Administration (GPA: 4.18)

University of New Mexico

SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Finance: Program Financial Ownership, EAC/ETC, EVM Concepts, Quantitative Modeling, US GAAP.

Tools: Advanced Excel (Macros, Modeling), R, Python, SQL, ERP/WMS Concepts.

Ops: Requirement Gathering, Backlog Management, Workflow Optimization, Federal Compliance.